



Evidence first. Then the room.

REGIONAL HEAD GUIDE

A six-month roadmap for building a De-Trap chapter, surveying your region, and putting the findings in front of people who can act on them.

6-MONTH ROADMAP • RESEARCH & ADVOCACY • GRADES 8-12

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A NOTE ON WHAT THIS PROGRAMME IS NOT

De-Trap teaches. It does not advise, counsel, mediate, or intervene. No volunteer, at any level, may recommend a financial product, help a student choose a lender, contact a lending company on anyone's behalf, or handle another person's money. A regional head who is unclear on this line should stop and write to the founder before the first workshop, not after.

On AI: permitted for drafting, layout, and language work. Prohibited for generating survey data, quotations, statistics, or citations. Every source you cite must have been opened and read by a named human on your team.

You are not the best volunteer.

You are the person accountable for whether this chapter produces something defensible or something embarrassing. Those are the only two outcomes. A regional head who teaches brilliantly but ships no data has failed the role.

WHAT YOU OWN

RESEARCH INTEGRITY

Every number that leaves your region carries your name. Sampling, consent, cleaning, and the honest reporting of what the data failed to show.

INSTITUTIONAL ACCESS

Schools, district education offices, and the written permissions that make everything else legal. No access, no chapter.

VOLUNTEER COMPETENCE

Nobody teaches a room until they pass the Month 1 mastery check. You administer it, and you are the one who has to fail people.

ESCALATION

Distress disclosures, data incidents, media requests, and any contact from a lending company go to the founder the same day. Not to the group chat.

THE TEAM YOU BUILD

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY	COUNT
Regional Head	Owns the roadmap, the report, and every escalation. Submits six branch reports.	1
Research Lead	Survey instrument, sampling plan, data cleaning, statistical write-up.	1
Outreach Lead	School approach, permissions, consent packs, event logistics, endorsements.	1
Content Lead	Workshop delivery quality, workbook stock, translation, social output.	1
Volunteers	Facilitate workshops, administer surveys, document sessions, transcribe interviews.	4–8

READ THIS BEFORE YOU RECRUIT

A chapter of six people who all passed the mastery check will outperform a chapter of twenty who did not. Enthusiasm is not a qualification here — a volunteer who explains compound interest wrongly to a hundred students has done net harm, and you will not find out for months.

Seven rules that end the chapter if broken.

Not guidelines. Breaking any one of these can end the initiative nationally, not just your region — through a lawsuit, a safeguarding complaint, or a single parent who was never asked.

1 Written parental consent for every respondent under 18.

A plain-language information sheet plus a signed consent form, in English and Hindi, before any student fills anything in. School permission is not parental consent. Retain the forms for the life of the dataset.

2 The survey is anonymous by design, not by promise.

No names, roll numbers, phone numbers, bank details, or app screenshots showing an account. If a field could re-identify a student when combined with their school and grade, it does not go in the instrument. Raw responses live in one access-controlled folder — never on a personal device, never forwarded on WhatsApp.

3 Never name a specific app or company as predatory.

Describe patterns, mechanics, and fee structures. Do not publish a named list. A defamation notice from a well-funded lender is the single most plausible way this initiative dies, and naming brands adds nothing pedagogically — the workbook already teaches students to read any offer.

4 No advice, ever. Disclosure triggers escalation, not help.

If a student discloses real debt, harassment, or distress: do not counsel, do not calculate their loan for them, do not contact anyone for them. Direct them to the school counsellor and a parent, point them at the workbook's rights page, and notify the founder the same day.

5 Every published claim carries a citation or an "our survey, n = X" tag.

No invented statistics, no borrowed figures without a checked source, no rounding a number up because it reads better. One fabricated figure discovered by a journalist discredits every real one.

6 Report what the data did not show.

Every draft includes a limitations section and a list of hypotheses that failed. A regional report with no negative findings is not a strong report — it is an unbelievable one.

7 No money moves through volunteers.

No collection of fees from schools or students, no reimbursements handled informally, no volunteer's personal account used for anything. Printing and event costs are cleared with the founder in advance, in writing.

MONTH ONE

Build the team. Then test it.

Objective: assemble a regional chapter that is actually competent in the subject matter, and secure the written school access that every later month depends on.

ACTIONS

- **Recruit 6–12 volunteers** and name your three sub-leads in writing. Publish the structure to the team so nobody is unclear who decides what.
- **Run the mastery check.** No volunteer facilitates a session until they can, unaided and from memory:
 - Explain the RE / LSP / DLA structure — why the app on the phone is usually not the lender.
 - Annualise a real offer: ₹2,000 borrowed for 15 days at a ₹100 fee → $5\% \times (365 \div 15) \approx 122\%$ a year.
 - Distinguish flat-rate from reducing-balance interest, and say which is more expensive and why.
 - Name four recovery practices that are already illegal under the RBI's Fair Practices Code.
 - State what a Key Fact Statement must contain, and what its absence signals.
- **Assigned reading for the whole team**, before any school contact:
 - RBI (Digital Lending) Directions, 2025 — dated 8 May 2025. Read the disbursal, KFS, APR and data-access provisions in full.
 - RBI Fair Practices Code and Recovery Agent Code of Conduct.
 - Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 — purpose limitation, consent, deletion rights.
 - The De-Trap workbook, cover to cover, with the exercises actually completed.
- **Map your region.** Identify 8–12 schools teaching Grades 8–12, deliberately mixing government, aided and private institutions. Log each in the shared tracker with a named contact and a date.
- **Make formal written approaches.** Partnership proposal plus a physical workbook sample to each principal. Follow up by phone within five working days — email alone has a very low hit rate with school administrations.
- **Secure the permission template** signed by at least two schools: what you will run, for how long, with which grades, and what data you will collect.

END-OF-MONTH TARGET

- ▶ Regional team of 6+ formed, with three named sub-leads.
- ▶ 100% of facilitating volunteers passed the mastery check, recorded by name and date.
- ▶ Written approach made to 8+ schools; 2+ in-person meetings held.
- ▶ Signed permission from 2+ schools covering the full six-month programme.
- ▶ Branch Report #1 submitted by the Regional Head.

MONTH TWO

A survey that survives a sceptic.

Objective: build an instrument that holds up when a principal, a parent, or a journalist asks how you know what you claim to know. This month produces no findings. It decides whether the findings will be worth anything.

ACTIONS

- **Draft the Regional Borrowing Exposure Survey.** Roughly 20 items, under eight minutes, anonymous. Cover six domains:
 - **Access** — own phone, UPI use, own bank account.
 - **Exposure** — has used or been offered BNPL, "pay in 3", instant-loan apps.
 - **Knowledge baseline** — can they define APR; do they know the app is usually not the lender; can they distinguish flat from reducing balance.
 - **Behavioural triggers** — the framing, present-bias, social-proof and gamification items from the workbook's self-check.
 - **Slip rate** — self-reported lateness on any obligation in the last six months.
 - **Household visibility** — whether borrowing is discussed at home at all. Ask about discussion, never about amounts.
- **Build it as a pre/post instrument.** The knowledge items are asked before the workshop and again four to six weeks after. Without the second administration you have an opinion about your programme, not evidence for it. Design this now — it cannot be retrofitted.
- **Pilot on 15–20 students** outside your sample. Rewrite every item that produces the question "what does this mean?" Formal Sanskrit-derived vocabulary in the Hindi version will lose Tier 2/3 readers; use everyday spoken equivalents.
- **Assemble the consent pack:** one-page parent information sheet, signed consent form, and a data-handling statement naming who holds the data and for how long. Both languages.
- **Write the sampling plan.** Name target schools, target n, and grade split. State your selection bias openly — surveying only the schools that said yes skews toward better-resourced private institutions, so deliberately pursue government and aided schools even though they are harder to access.
- **Get written sign-off** on the instrument and consent pack from at least one school administration before fieldwork opens.

END-OF-MONTH TARGET

- ▶ Survey instrument v1.0 finalised in English and Hindi, piloted and revised.
- ▶ Consent pack approved by at least one school administration.
- ▶ Written sampling plan with named schools, target n, and a stated bias limitation.
- ▶ 1 social post explaining the research — not the findings, which do not exist yet.
- ▶ Branch Report #2 submitted.

MONTH THREE

Collect the baseline. Teach the room.

Objective: run workshops at scale and capture the pre-workshop data that every later claim rests on. Sequence matters — the survey comes **before** the teaching, or the baseline is contaminated.

THE STANDARD SESSION

45

MINUTES,
ONE CLASS PERIOD

4

SCHOOLS MINIMUM
THIS MONTH

300

COMPLETED PRE-SURVEYS
ACROSS THE REGION

ACTIONS

- **Run the fixed sequence at every school**, without exception: parental consent collected → pre-survey administered → 45-minute workshop delivered from the standard deck → workbook distributed → post-survey scheduled for four to six weeks later, in writing, with the teacher.
- **Two facilitators per room minimum.** One teaches, one manages the survey, counts, and handles anything the room throws up. Never send a volunteer alone.
- **Document every session:** attendance count, date, grade, school type, and photographs. No identifiable student faces in anything published without separate written consent from that student's parent.
- **Collect qualitative material** alongside the numbers:
 - 5–8 teacher interviews — what they see, what the school has tried, what they think is missing.
 - Student accounts only where volunteered, never solicited by name, and always anonymised at the point of writing.
- **Data hygiene every week.** One named person enters, de-identifies and backs up responses within 48 hours of collection. Paper forms are destroyed after entry; consent forms are not.
- **Hold a mid-month reflection meeting.** What is the room actually reacting to? Which workbook page lands and which one dies? Feed this to the national team — the materials are supposed to change based on your region.

END-OF-MONTH TARGET

- ▶ 4+ schools delivered; 300+ completed and cleaned pre-surveys.
- ▶ 5+ teacher interviews recorded and transcribed.
- ▶ Post-survey dates confirmed in writing with every participating school.
- ▶ 2 reels/posts produced. Branch Report #3 submitted.

MONTH FOUR

Turn responses into findings.

Objective: produce a regional report that an economist could read without wincing.

This is the month where most student research quietly overclaims, and the month where yours must not.

ACTIONS

- **Clean the dataset and publish your exclusions.** Report how many responses were dropped, and why — incomplete, contradictory, or obviously non-serious. Concealing the exclusion count is how research loses its credibility fastest.
- **Compute the core figures:** exposure rate to BNPL and instant-loan offers; knowledge baseline on each item; breakdowns by grade band and school type; self-reported slip rate. Confidence intervals where your n supports them, and an honest statement where it does not.
- **Run the failure audit.** Write down every hypothesis the data did not support. That list goes into the published report, not into a drawer.
- **Structure the report** in this order: method and limitations first, findings second. Putting limitations at the back is what advocacy documents do; putting them at the front is what credible ones do.
- **Ground your framing in the actual literature.** The strongest available support is **Kaiser, Lusardi, Menkhoff & Urban (2022)**, *Journal of Financial Economics* — a meta-analysis of financial-education randomised trials finding measurable positive effects on both financial knowledge and downstream behaviour.
- **Do not cite Fernandes, Lynch & Netemeyer (2014) as support.** It argues the opposite of our position — that financial-literacy interventions explain a negligible share of variance in financial behaviour and decay rapidly. Cite it only as the counter-argument you are explicitly answering, and answer it properly or leave it out.
- **Red-team the draft internally.** Assign one teammate the sole job of attacking it: every unsupported claim, every number without a source, every conclusion the data does not reach. Their memo is attached to the draft you send the founder.

THE CLAIM YOU ARE ALLOWED TO MAKE

With one region, no control group, and a self-selected sample of schools, you can honestly say: *'Among X students surveyed across Y schools in [region], Z% had been offered a 'pay later' product, and knowledge of who actually holds the loan rose from A% to B% after a single session.'* You cannot say the programme reduces debt, changes long-run behaviour, or generalises to India. Stating the smaller claim precisely is far more persuasive than stating the larger one loosely.

END-OF-MONTH TARGET

- ▶ Cleaned dataset with documented exclusions; full first draft of the regional report.
- ▶ Red-team memo completed and attached. 2 reels/posts. Branch Report #4 submitted.

MONTH FIVE

Put it in front of people who decide.

Objective: publish the regional report and convert it into institutional commitments. A report nobody with authority has read is a school project, not advocacy.

ACTIONS

- **Finalise and design the regional report** in De-Trap house style. Public PDF, versioned and dated, with the method section intact. Send to the national team for consolidation before release.
- **Host a De-Trap Regional Briefing.** Findings presented by the students who collected them — not by adults speaking about students. Invite principals, teachers, parents, the district education office, and local press.
- **Prepare the room properly:**
 - Findings boards and stat cards, not dense graphs. The workbook's visual grammar works here.
 - A live two-minute demonstration of the annualisation calculation from workbook page 9. It is the single most persuasive thing you have.
 - Printed one-page summary for every attendee to take away.
- **Make formal submissions** with a covering letter, the report, and a specific concrete ask — a recurring curriculum slot, not a vague appeal for "awareness":
 - Managements of every participating school.
 - The district education office.
 - Any state-level financial literacy or consumer-affairs cell that exists in your state.
- **Collect written endorsements.** A signed statement from a principal saying the session was useful and they intend to repeat it is worth more to the next region than any social metric.
- **Log every institutional interaction** — date, person, designation, what was said, what was promised. This log is the backbone of Month 6.

END-OF-MONTH TARGET

- ▶ Regional report published and released publicly.
- ▶ 1 Regional Briefing held, with students presenting.
- ▶ Formal submission to 3+ institutions with a specific, written ask.
- ▶ 2+ written endorsements secured. 2 reels/posts. Branch Report #5 submitted.

MONTH SIX

Measure it. Then hand it over.

Objective: run the post-surveys that make the pre/post claim real, chase every institutional promise, and leave the region in a state where a successor can run it without you.

ACTIONS

- **Administer the post-surveys.** These are now due for every school taught in Month 3. This is the month your central claim either exists or does not — treat it as the highest-priority activity of the entire six months, above events and above social output.
- **Compute and publish the pre/post delta** per knowledge item, alongside the response rate. A 40% post-survey completion rate must be reported as such; attrition that high weakens the claim and hiding it destroys it.
- **Chase every institutional promise** from Month 5 in writing. Log official responses, curriculum decisions, media pickup, and meeting minutes.
- **Compile the Regional Impact Dossier:**
 - The published report and the pre/post addendum.
 - Complete session log — schools, grades, dates, student counts.
 - Every institutional interaction and its outcome.
 - Endorsements, media coverage, and event documentation.
- **Write the replication note** for the next regional head. A mandatory, specific failures section: which schools refused and what they said, which workbook pages did not land, what you would sequence differently. Vague self-congratulation here wastes the next region's first two months.
- **Hand over formally.** Name a successor, transfer folder access, archive the dataset with its consent forms, and brief them live rather than by document alone.

END-OF-MONTH TARGET

- ▶ Post-surveys administered; completion of 60%+ of the Month 3 pre-survey sample.
- ▶ Pre/post findings published with response rates and attrition stated.
- ▶ Regional Impact Dossier released; replication note written.
- ▶ Successor named and access transferred. Branch Report #6 submitted.

What a region looks like at **month six.**

These are proposed defaults for a first chapter, not validated benchmarks. Calibrate them against your region's actual school access in Month 1 and tell the founder what you are changing and why — a target quietly missed is worse than a target openly revised.

6+

 SCHOOLS
DELIVERED

500+

 STUDENTS
TAUGHT

300+

 SURVEYS
ANALYSED

MONTH

THE ONE THING THAT MUST EXIST BY THE END OF IT

One	A competent team. Every facilitator has passed the mastery check, and 2+ schools have signed a written permission.
Two	A defensible instrument. Bilingual, piloted, pre/post by design, with a consent pack a parent could read in two minutes.
Three	A baseline. 300+ clean pre-surveys and 4+ schools taught, with post-survey dates already in writing.
Four	An honest draft. Findings, limitations, failed hypotheses, and a red-team memo attached.
Five	A submission. The report in the hands of 3+ institutions with a specific written ask attached.
Six	A measured effect and a successor. Pre/post delta published with attrition stated; the region runs without you.

BY THE END OF SIX MONTHS

- A published, citable regional report on borrowing exposure and credit literacy among Grades 8–12 students in your region — the first evidence base De-Trap owns rather than borrows.
- A measured pre/post change in credit knowledge, reported with its limitations rather than around them.
- Formal submissions lodged with school managements and at least one government education body, each with a specific curricular ask.
- A trained regional team, at least one of whom can run the next cycle without the founder's involvement.
- A replication note that makes the next region faster than yours was.
- Volunteers who can annualise a real credit offer in under two minutes and explain to an adult why the app is not the lender.

Reporting. escalation, templates.

THE MONTHLY BRANCH REPORT

Due to **detrapcs@gmail.com** within five days of month end. Two pages maximum — a long report is usually a report avoiding something.

SECTION 1 · DELIVERED

Schools, dates, grades, student counts. Surveys collected and cleaned. Interviews recorded.

SECTION 2 · MISSED

Every target not met, with the actual reason. "Ongoing" is not a reason.

SECTION 3 · INSTITUTIONAL

Each contact: person, designation, date, what was said, what was promised, next step.

SECTION 4 · ASKS

What you need from the national team — materials, translation, a decision, an introduction.

ESCALATE THE SAME DAY — DO NOT WAIT FOR THE MONTHLY REPORT



Any student disclosure of debt, harassment, or distress.

Notify the founder, the school counsellor and the student's parent. Volunteers do not handle this alone and do not attempt to resolve it.



Any data incident.

A lost form, a shared folder link, a spreadsheet forwarded to a personal account. Report it even if you think nothing came of it.



Any contact from a lending company, app, or their legal representative.

Do not reply. Forward it. This is precisely why we never publish brand names.



Any press or government request for comment.

Regional heads do not speak for the initiative nationally. Route it to the founder and let the national position be a single one.

ONE OUTSTANDING DECISION FOR THE NATIONAL TEAM

De-Trap's materials currently describe the audience as Grades 8–12 in some documents and Grades 9–12 in others. This guide uses **Grades 8–12** throughout, matching the workbook. Confirm the band with the founder before your first school approach and make it consistent everywhere — a principal who notices the discrepancy in a proposal will read it as carelessness, and they will be right.

The trap was never the money. It was the silence.

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